Javier Ponz

Technical support · support engineering · agent operations

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PROFILE

Ten years of technical support at Apple as a Genius, a remote AppleCare advisor and an in-store Lead: diagnosing faults I'd never seen, escalating cases someone could act on, and training the technicians who came after me. Colleagues used my case notes as the example to follow. Today Hermes runs my day: I build plugins for it (two in the Nous Research hackathon), run my own VPS and ship small tools as a vibe coder. I spec and test; AI agents write the code. Looking for support and customer-facing roles around open agents, and to help a support team grow.

Independent since August 2024, in Aberdeen: studying and building in public. Machines Do It Better, my main project (pre-launch): AI agents set up for people on open models and harnesses like Hermes, so they own them. Two Hermes plugins in the Nous Research hackathon; Neuronara, built for my partner, a clinical neurophysiologist. All vibe-coded: I specify, test and ship; AI coding agents write the code. All on a VPS I administer; javierponz.technoir.cloud and github.com/ponzgpt.

EXPERIENCE

Lead In-Store Experience · Apple Retail (secondment, twice) Feb – Aug 2023; Feb – Aug 2024
Xanadú (Arroyomolinos), then Parquesur (Leganés), Madrid

- From the bench into leadership, twice: seven-month secondments taken while holding the Genius role. Worked alongside the management team as the link between them and the floor, running the store from opening to close: staffing and team breaks, customer flow, logistics.
- Trained technical and sales staff, ran weekly cross-team alignment and co-owned scheduling optimisation; handled what no procedure covered. Noted by my manager for high visibility with the Support team and store leadership.

Genius · Apple Retail March 2018 – August 2024
Parquesur, Leganés, Madrid

- Diagnosed and repaired Mac, iPhone and iPad hardware and software faults, owning each case through post-repair checks; repair times among the shortest on the team while covering front-of-house support; NPS stable and at or above the team average.
- Colleagues used my case notes as the example to follow; standardised documentation to Apple guidelines, which shortened their appointments. Proposed repair-room process fixes to store leadership and linked Support with the stockroom on dead-on-arrival parts.
- Mentored newer technicians and new Geniuses through shadowing and case feedback; trusted by Lead Geniuses to run floor resourcing and walk-in triage.

AppleCare Support Advisor · Apple March – June 2020
Remote, Madrid · COVID volunteering

- Remote, asynchronous support: Tier 1 by phone, email and chat, several cases at once, each owned from first contact to resolution under structured troubleshooting and documentation standards.
- Escalated what Tier 1 could not resolve: documented the case, briefed Tier 2 first, then a live three-way handoff with the customer.

Specialist, then Technical Specialist · Apple Retail September 2014 – February 2018
Parquesur, Madrid

- Foundations in diagnosis, consultative support and execution under pressure.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Specialist in Artificial Intelligence 2024 – 2026, in progress
Universidad Rey Juan Carlos, via Racks University

Full Stack AI Developer 2025 – 2026, in progress
Universidad Rey Juan Carlos, via Racks University

Industrial Engineering (Electronics and Automation) 2008 – 2013, 80 ECTS, not completed
Universidad Politécnica de Madrid

Apple Certified Mac Technician (ACMT) · Apple Certified iOS Technician (ACiT) · English, Cambridge CAE (C1)

SKILLS

Agents and AI: Hermes Agent, Model Context Protocol (MCP), agent workflows, workflow QA, OpenRouter, llama.cpp, Ollama, local inference, prompt and failure-trace debugging.

Infrastructure and deployment: Docker, Docker Swarm, Dokploy, Traefik, nginx, Linux: Arch, Fedora, Omarchy, VPS administration, GitHub Actions, CI/CD.

Building (vibe-coded, with AI coding agents): Claude Code, Codex, specs and acceptance tests, testing and verifying agent output, Git, shipped in JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Astro.

Practice: Technical support, customer success, technical troubleshooting, failure-mode investigation, documentation, mentoring, team leadership.

Building towards: vLLM, Proxmox, self-hosted homelab, agent operations.

Languages: Spanish (native), English (Cambridge CAE, C1).